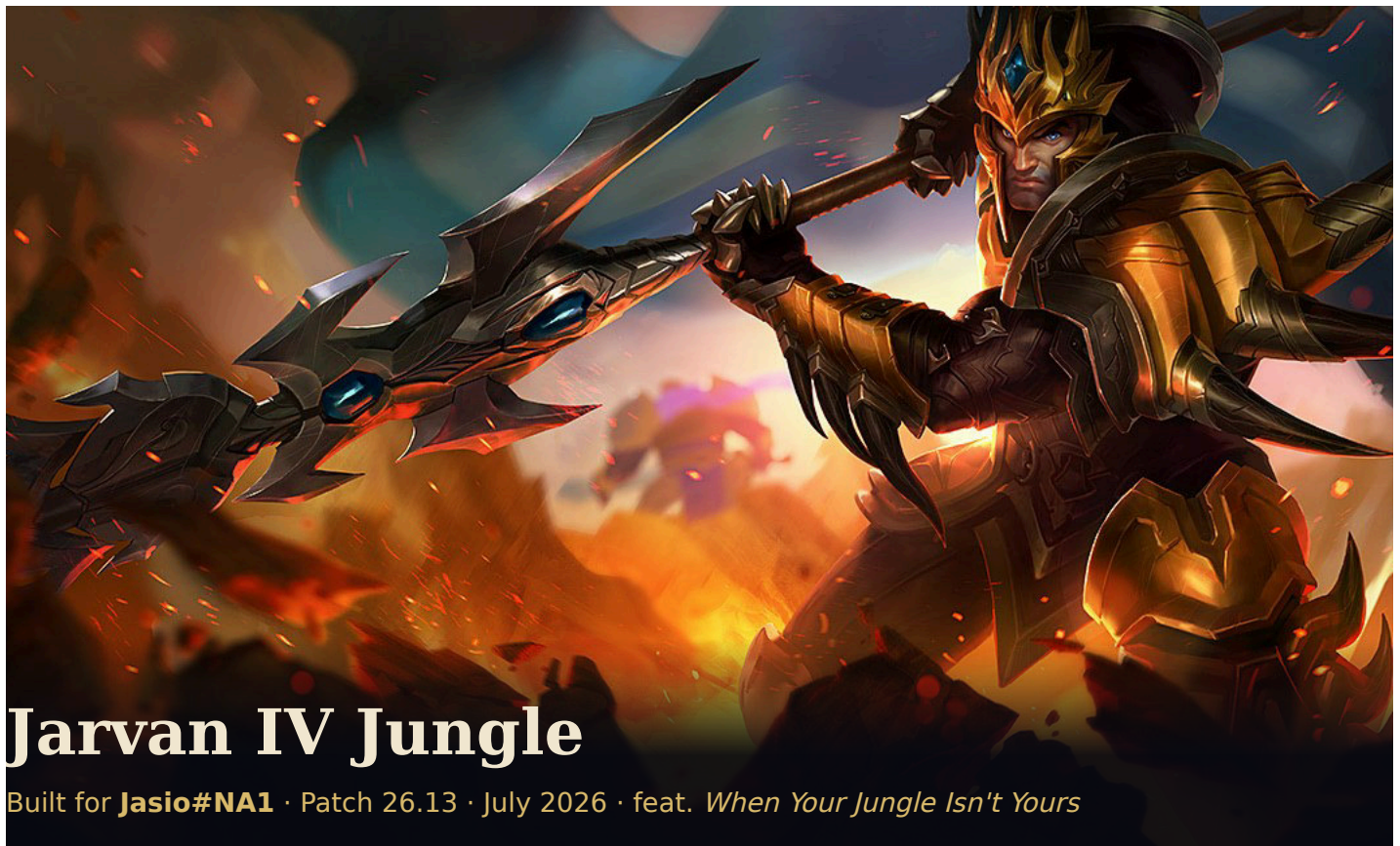




Jarvan IV Jungle

Built for **Jasio#NA1** · Patch 26.13 · July 2026 · feat. *When Your Jungle Isn't Yours*

How to read the labels: **VERIFIED** multi-source, adversarially fact-checked · **SINGLE SOURCE** one reputable source · **REASONING** game-knowledge, verify in your own games. Stats are lolalytics patch 26.13, Emerald+ unless marked. Requested by Campbell (soup minion#NA1); a special chapter covers your question — *what do I do when I'm constantly invaded?* — in §6.

1 • The Snapshot

VERIFIED Jarvan IV is **S- tier, the #7 jungler of 77** at Emerald+ (52.1% WR, n=153,547) and **#6 of 80 at Gold** (50.4%, n=94,060) on 26.13. He hasn't been patched since 25.19 — everything here is stable, not flavor-of-the-month.

VERIFIED **You, specifically** (op.gg, 2026-07-06): Platinum 3 solo queue, 59% WR — climbing. Your Jarvan is 4 games old, all **top lane**, and it's working (3W-1L, 5.7 KDA, 71% kill participation) — this guide moves that success to jungle. Your current jungle volume pick is Nunu (13W-18L, 42%), and your Nunu losses cluster against early duelists who invade: **Viego 0-3, Kayn 0-2, Lee Sin 0-2**. That's not a coincidence — it's the exact problem §6 exists to solve, and J4 handles all three of those matchups at even-or-better (§7). One more number from your recent games: **zero control wards** in your last four. Hold that thought until §6c.

REASONING What he is: the best **level-2-3 engage jungler** in the game — E-Q knockup is a gank that works from behind a wall, before most junglers have a gank at all. What he is **not**: a 1v1 duelist (dedicated duelists beat him in isolated fights — see §6 and §7) or a late-game carry (he falls off; his job after 25 minutes is engage + peel, not damage). Your whole game plan flows from this: **use early tempo to bank objectives, then cash out before scaling junglers outgrow you.**

2 · The Kit — Numbers That Matter

Ability	What it actually does
 P · Martial Cadence	VERIFIED First basic attack on each target: 8% of their CURRENT health as bonus physical damage (min 20). Capped at 400 vs monsters only — uncapped vs champions . Per-target cooldown 6/5/4/3s by level. Jungle engine: first hit on every buff is huge. In fights: auto early while they're full HP , and spread autos across fresh targets.
 Q · Dragon Strike	VERIFIED 90–250 (+145% bonus AD) physical in a line, shreds 10–26% of armor for 3s , CD 10→6s, 0.4s cast. If the lance touches your E flag, you dash to it, knocking up everything on the path for 0.75s — and the dash executes even if you're rooted or grounded when it connects.
 W · Golden Aegis	VERIFIED Shield 60–140 (+70% bonus AD) +1.3% of your max HP per enemy champion hit (4s), and slows all of them 15–35% for 2s. Flat 9s CD. Rule: cast it after you land in their team, not before — every champion in the 625 radius makes it bigger.
 E · Demacian Standard	VERIFIED Passive: +20–30% attack speed, permanently (this is why it's your level-1 skill for clearing). Active: flag deals 80–240 magic, stands 8s, gives the same AS aura to nearby allies (radius 1000). Range 860, no cast time — which is what makes the instant E-Q possible.
 R · Cataclysm	VERIFIED 200/325/450 (+180% bonus AD) physical, 0.35s displacement-immune leap, then a 3.5s ring of real terrain . Enemies near the edge get shoved out; everyone else gets pulled in. Recast (available after 0.75s) collapses the wall. It IS crossable by dashes and Flash — R traps immobile champions, not mobile ones. CD 120/105/90.

3 • Combos

Combo	Buttons	When & why
Instant E-Q (the gank)	E+Q same instant	E has no cast time, so buffering both fires a near-instant 0.75s knockup at ~770 range. This is your bread and butter — from fog, over walls, before they can react.
Full gank string	E→Q → AA → W → (R)	Knockup → auto (passive chunk while they're full HP) → W slow so they can't walk away when the knockup ends. R only if they'll escape or to wall off help.
EQ-Flash	E→Q, Flash mid-dash	VERIFIED Flash during the E-Q dash: the dash stops but the knockup still applies at your new position. Direction correction — they sidestep, you Flash the knockup back onto them.
Jail-break	R → E outside wall → Q	Trap them in R, then E-Q over your own wall and leave. The cage stays up 3.5s without you in it. Use when their team collapses or you're low.
Escape E-Q	E over terrain → Q	Your only escape — a wall-hop on a ~10-12s cooldown. If you burned E-Q engaging and the fight turns, you are not leaving. Decide before you jump.
R discipline	R center-mass; recast when done	Land R so the target is inside , not on the rim (rim = shoved out). Recast the moment the kill is secured — a standing cage traps your own immobile teammates too.

VERIFIED Tech notes: the E-Q pull executes even while immobilized (rooted mid-dash still pulls). Enemies dodge R with any dash/blink — hold it until their dash is down, or use it as a **wall** (cut a choke, block a path) rather than a cage vs mobile champs. W's slow is your gank stick pre-6: E-Q → AA → W keeps them in auto range for your laner.

4 • Runes & Build

Piece	Choice	Notes
Keystone	 Conqueror (Precision)	VERIFIED 94.3% pick, 52.1% WR (n=144,761). Nothing else is close — your fights are extended skirmishes and Conqueror stacks fully in them.
Minors	Triumph · Legend: Alacrity · Coup de Grace	VERIFIED The standard page. Directional upgrades: Legend: Haste 53.4% (n=7,139), Cut Down 52.7% vs 2+ tanks (n=15,234).
Secondary	Inspiration: Cosmic Insight + Magical Footwear	VERIFIED 77% of pages, 52.4%. Shards: Attack Speed / Adaptive / Health.
Summoners & start	Flash + Smite ·  Scorchclaw pup + potion	VERIFIED Flash+Smite is 99.9% of games. Scorchclaw (red pet) 63% pick; its slow-and-burn helps ganks stick.
First item	 Sundered Sky (default) or  Profane Hydra (stat pick)	VERIFIED Sundered: 51.6% of games, most forgiving — the crit-heal keeps you alive through skirmishes. Profane Hydra wins on stats (53.8% vs 51.6% at Emerald+, +2.0pp over Sundered at Gold, n=18k+) — faster clears, execute resets. Honest read: Hydra is the better item if your early game is clean; Sundered forgives mistakes. Eclipse (16.9% pick) is the distant third.
Boots	 Merces /  Steelcaps	VERIFIED Steelcaps are picked more (48%) but Merces win more (54.0% vs 51.9%; same gap at Gold). Pick by their damage profile, but when in doubt vs mixed comps, Merces — you engage into CC every fight.
Second item	 Black Cleaver (default) or  Axiom Arc	VERIFIED Cleaver 38.2% pick, 53.1% — your E-Q + R hit multiple people and stack it fast, and its shred + Q's shred strips frontlines. Axiom Arc is the sleeper: 55.4% WR (n=22,284) — takedowns refund R, and more Cataclysms = more picks. Take Axiom when ahead and snowballing kills.
3rd-5th	 Death's Dance ·  GA ·  Frozen Heart ·  Spirit Visage ·  Sterak's ·  Maw	VERIFIED After two damage items you pivot tanky — you're the engage button and you die first if you don't. DD 58.5% at slot 3; GA 64.3% (inflated by survivorship, but the pattern is real: winners buy defense 3rd). Maw/Rookern vs AP, Frozen Heart vs crit/AS, Visage with healing comps.
Situational	 Serylda's ·  Serpent's Fang ·  Edge of Night ·  Kaenic Rookern	VERIFIED Serylda's 60.4% by-game WR when armor stacks; Serpent's vs shield comps; EoN to survive the first spell when you engage; Rookern vs heavy AP.

VERIFIED Skill order: **E at 1** (attack speed for the clear) → Q at 2 → W at 3 (83.5%). Max **Q > E > W**, R at 6/11/16 — 95% consensus, 53.0% WR.

5 • The Clear — Season 2026 Timers

VERIFIED **Patch 26.01 sped up the whole early jungle and most guides never updated:** buffs now spawn at **0:55** (was 1:30), Gromp/Krugs at **1:07** (was 1:42), first scuttle at **2:55** (was 3:30). If a guide says "scuttle at 3:30," it's stale. Everything happens ~35s earlier now — including the enemy's invade window.

SINGLE SOURCE Standard route (jungler.gg 26.12, matches the lolalytics skill data): **Red brambleback (E first for attack speed) → Krugs → Raptors** — that's level 3 around 2:05-2:15, your first E-Q gank or scuttle window — → **Wolves → Blue → Gromp**, full clear ~3:15-3:35 at level 4, then scuttle/gank. Start Raptors→Red→Krugs when you want the faster level-3 gank on bot side. **REASONING** E-Q the multi-camps (raptors, wolves, krugs) — the knockup path hits everything; drop E for its AS aura before big single targets. W on cooldown at buffs/Gromp to shave damage taken. Aim to end the first clear above 60% HP; time yourself once in practice tool.

Camp	First spawn	Respawn	Gold	XP
Blue Sentinel / Red Brambleback	0:55	5:00	90	95-142
Wolves / Raptors	0:55	2:15	85 / 75	80-120 / 70-105
Gromp / Krugs	1:07	2:15	80 / 81	120-180 / ~90-134
Rift Scuttler	2:55	2:30	55-121	100-150

VERIFIED against wiki camp pages 2026-07-06. Respawn timers become visible to *both* teams 60s out for buffs, 10s out for small camps — that's a tracking tool (\$6). Camps level with the game's average, so late camps aren't XP-dead.

6 · When Your Jungle Isn't Yours

Your current habit, graded

REASONING "If I can't find camps I look for ganks" is **half right, and the half that's right is genuinely right** — Jarvan is a gank champion, and doing *something* beats standing in an empty jungle. The problem is the ungated version. A gank into a bad lane state gives you 0 gold and 0 XP **while the invader who took your camps farms freely** — you don't just fail to gain, you fall further behind on both ends. That's the compounding loss that turns one stolen camp into a lost jungle. The fix isn't "stop ganking" — it's a 10-second checklist before you commit, and a better default when the checklist fails.

6a · The gank checklist — go only on 2 or more

VERIFIED (Dodge.gg 2026 jungle guide) Count these before walking to a lane: **(1)** enemy pushed past the river line · **(2)** their Flash/escape is down · **(3)** your laner has CC to chain your knockup · **(4)** the wave is pushing toward your tower · **(5)** you have a level or item edge · **(6)** lane likely unwarded. **Fewer than two: don't go.** "A jungler who waits for the right gank outperforms a jungler who ganks constantly with low success." One more that's yours specifically: **REASONING** never gank a losing lane to "help" — you're feeding a shutdown into the player already beating your teammate.

6b · The four answers to an invade — in order

Play	When	How
1. Mirror-farm (the default)	You find a camp gone, or spot him entering your side	VERIFIED Don't chase — cross the map and take his matching camps . He took your Red side? His Red side is standing empty. Steal the big monster only and leave the smalls: the camp can't start its respawn timer, so his side stays dead longer. Get in, take it, get out — "each second in the enemy jungle is more dangerous than the last."
2. Counter-gank (the J4 special)	You <i>know</i> where he is (he's in YOUR jungle)	REASONING An invader's position is information. If he's eating your bot-side camps, he is not defending his top laner — and you have the best level-3 engage in the game. This is the disciplined version of your instinct: gank because you know where he isn't , not because your camps are gone. Checklist still applies.
3. Fight him (gated)	A laner can arrive before his does, OR you win the matchup	VERIFIED A 2v1 in your own jungle is a won fight — ping immediately, fight when they commit. But solo? J4 is a skirmisher with backup, not a duelist : Trundle, Poppy, Rek'Sai, Elise, Kindred, Bel'Veth all beat you isolated (\$7). No help + no matchup edge = walk away. "Take camps, not fights."
4. Concede & powerfarm (the reset)	Behind, low HP, or no good option	VERIFIED Swap to your opposite side and farm everything, toward the next objective spawn. The game pays you to do this: once you're >1.1 levels below average, every large monster gives +50 bonus XP per level you're behind . Catch-up XP refunds farming — it refunds nothing for wandering. Above all: don't die . Dying to the invader hands him your whole jungle on repeat.

6c · Track him so it stops happening

- VERIFIED** **Loading screen:** level-1 invades come from hard-CC comps (Blitzcrank, Braum, Trundle, Olaf). See one? Expect your bot-side buff to be contested — start top-side, or ward your entrance at ~1:00 and stand in the river bush with your team.
- VERIFIED** **Start-side detection:** if their bot lane shows up late to lane, they leashed — their jungler started bot-side. On time = top-side start. Now you know which of your camps he can reach and when.
- VERIFIED** **The TAB rule:** each camp is 4 CS. Check his CS on the scoreboard: 8 = two camps, 12 = three camps and level 3 — **he can gank now**; 24 = full clear. Do this every time you back.
- VERIFIED** **Ward at 3:00** — river or pixel brush, when first clears end and junglers start moving. Your own stolen camps help too: respawn timers show to both teams 60s out (buffs), so a visible timer on your Red tells you when he might come back for it. **REASONING** This is the \$1 callback: your last four games had **zero control wards**. A jungler who buys no pinks is invisible-blind in his own jungle — one control ward per back, planted at your most-invaded entrance, is the single cheapest fix to "I keep getting invaded." It's 75g for the information every rule in this chapter runs on.
- VERIFIED** **Track intention, not just location.** A Kayn wants your camps; an Elise wants your laners at level 3. Knowing what he wants predicts where he'll be — and where you should be.

The math, so it sticks

VERIFIED One camp $\approx$ 75–90 gold + a chunk of a level (table in §5); small camps respawn every 2:15, so a farming jungler banks $\sim$ 3–4 camps' value in the time two failed roams take. A kill is worth 300g (400 first blood) plus XP — roughly 2–4 camps — **but only if it lands**, and an off-resources gank at Silver–Gold usually doesn't. Meanwhile his uncontested farm keeps flowing. **REASONING** The loop that beats invades long-term is boring: **Clear $\rightarrow$ ONE play $\rightarrow$ reset**. Farm what's up, make one checklist-approved play, recall, repeat. Windows where the "play" is strongest: level 3 ($\sim$ 2:15), after full clear ($\sim$ 3:30–4:00), your first-item spike, and level 6.

7 • Matchups

VERIFIED Numbers below are Emerald+ (the cut closest to your Plat 3, big samples). One nuance first: **duel-winners and game-winners are different lists**. Trundle beats you 1v1 in every early duel — yet J4 wins 55.9% of games vs Trundle (n=388), because good Jarvans just don't fight him and out-tempo the map. Losing the duel $\neq$ losing the game, as long as you refuse the duel.

vs You (Emerald+, 26.13)	WR (n)	Plan
Feast on: Locke · Volibear · Rammus · Trundle · Zed · Lillia · Zac	60.4 (3,471) · 57.4 (671) · 56.0 (1,046) · 55.9 (388) · 55.7 (1,595) · 55.3 (1,807) · 55.0 (1,770)	Play your normal tempo game — your engage outpaces them, or they need time you won't give. (Vs Trundle: win by refusing, see above.)
Your old tormentors: Viego · Kayn · Lee Sin · Graves	50.8 (7,260) · 51.8 (5,290) · 52.5 (11,868) · 50.4 (9,048)	VERIFIED The junglers who went a combined 0–7 against your Nunu are all even or J4-favored on Jarvan. You don't have to outfarm them anymore — you out-engage them. Skirmish 2v2 at scuttle with lane priority; your E-Q is the fight-starter Nunu never had.
Respect: Cho'Gath · Aatrox · Ivern · Talon · Nasus · Elise · Briar · Rek'Sai	46.9 (318) · 48.6 (1,135) · 49.0 (929) · 49.2 (3,671) · 49.4 (2,517) · 49.5 (1,576) · 49.8 (3,388) · 49.9 (1,267)	REASONING Two flavors: early bullies who beat you in skirmishes (Aatrox, Elise, Briar, Rek'Sai — don't duel, mirror-farm per §6) and scale-monsters (Cho, Nasus — kills aren't enough; convert every gank into grubs/dragon and press to end before 30, or your S-tier early game evaporates). At Gold-and-below the scaler problem gets even worse — games run longer and leads get wasted — so as a Plat player, closing speed is your edge.
Invade-duelists (they take YOUR camps): Trundle · Poppy · Rek'Sai · Elise · Kindred	duel-losers, game-winnable	SINGLE SOURCE Poppy W cancels your E-Q dash mid-flight; Trundle pillar traps you inside your own R; Rek'Sai/Elise out-duel you pre-6; Kindred wins if you over-commit. Vs all five: §6 rules — mirror-farm, don't duel, and ward your entrances because they're coming .